ISO 26000 Guidance on social responsibility

Service information sheet. Sustainability and Supply Chain. Information checked 11 October 2026.

In brief

ISO 26000 is the international guidance on social responsibility. It covers seven core subjects from governance and human rights to community involvement. It is not certifiable; ICFC uses it to assess your current practices and build a practical social responsibility roadmap.

What it is

ISO 26000 gives guidance on social responsibility across seven core subjects, including governance, human rights, labour practices, environment, fair operating practices, consumer issues and community involvement.

Who it is for

Organisations shaping their sustainability or ESG approach and stakeholder engagement.

How ICFC helps

Service	What we offer
Audit	No certification: ISO 26000 is a guidance document and is not intended for certification. Alignment assessment: First-party and second-party assessments that score how well your practices align with the guidance, with a practical gap report. Supplier checks: Second-party reviews of suppliers or partners against the guidance where your customers expect it.
Consulting	Funding: We explain which scheme, if any, applies and what it requires before you commit. Non-grant: A fixed-scope engagement: gap assessment, documentation, implementation coaching, internal audit and management review, and support through the formal audit or assessment. How we work: Practical, proportionate systems that your staff can run after we leave.
Training	Classroom: Public and in-house classroom courses on ISO 26000: awareness, implementation and internal auditor levels. Online LMS: Self-paced and live-online courses on the ICFC Digital LMS, with progress tracking and certificates of completion. Funding: Funding depends on each course's approval status, shown on the course page in the LMS.

Funding

Not on the EDGE Standards list. We did not find this standard on the EDGE Standards list when we checked. Ask us about non-grant options or other schemes that may apply.

Impartiality

Impartiality comes first. Every engagement begins with a conflict-of-interest check. We keep consulting and auditing roles separate, and our auditors never audit, on behalf of a certification body, an organisation that ICFC has consulted on the same scope within the period set by that body.

Frequently asked questions

Q. Is ISO 26000 certifiable?
A. No. It is explicitly a guidance standard. Be cautious of anyone offering certification to it.

Q. How does it relate to sustainability reporting?
A. It helps decide what matters before you report; reporting frameworks then guide disclosure.

Q. Which core subjects matter for us?
A. That comes out of a materiality and stakeholder review, which we facilitate.

Q. Can it be combined with ISO 37001?
A. Yes. Fair operating practices include anti-corruption.

Related services

- ISO 20400 Sustainable procurement (guidance)
- Sustainability reporting assessment (training only)

- Worldwide Responsible Accredited Production (WRAP)
- ISO 37001 Anti-Bribery Management System (ABMS)

Talk to us

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